FREE STARTER KIT · OPERATOR PLAYBOOK

DropIn AI Editor

One raw recording in. A batch of finished, captioned, self-checked vertical clips out. One command, one operator.

The same short-form system a full editing team would run, packaged so you can run it from your own Claude Code. Bring your footage and your style, then ship.

What this is

DropIn AI Editor turns one long recording (a Q&A, podcast, interview or talk) into a set of vertical clips that are ready to post. It transcribes the footage, finds the strongest moments, cuts them cleanly, reframes to 9:16 around the speaker's face, burns in word-by-word captions, lays music under the voice, and checks its own work before anything is called done.

There is no app to log into. It is a set of skills that run inside **Claude Code on your machine**, driving a short list of proven tools. Your Claude Code session is the editor: it reads the bundled editorial playbooks and makes the cut and caption decisions itself, so you never need a separate model API key.

1
command
Point it at footage, say how many clips you want, and let it work.

6
check gates
Mechanics, story, picture, sound, captions and script, each checked on its own.

1
operator
No editing team needed. You review the finished batch.

The loop it feeds

Every batch you post teaches you what lands. Feed that back in and the next batch gets sharper.

Create
The clip engine turns raw footage into posts.

Distribute
Post on every short-form platform.

Learn
See which hooks and topics win.

Compound
Same input, better clips each round.

02 · THE STACK

Every tool inside it

Nothing here is exotic. The value is in the orchestration: the kit runs these tools in the right order and checks what comes out. You bring your own accounts where a tool needs one.

TOOL	JOB IN THE PIPELINE	COST
Claude Code	The editor. Reads the editorial playbooks, picks the moments, designs cuts and captions, runs every step.	your plan
AssemblyAI	Primary transcription with word timings, speaker labels and filler words: the timeline every cut hangs on.	your key
Gemini	Listens to the source audio and writes listener notes that help pick and order moments.	your key
Groq (Whisper)	Second transcription for the audit gates and a fallback path.	free tier
ffmpeg + libass	Cutting, encoding and burning captions into the picture.	free
OpenCV + YuNet	Face detection and tracking for the 16:9 to 9:16 reframe.	free
tesseract	Reads the burned captions back so the caption gate can check them.	free
yt-dlp / rclone	Pull footage from a link or a cloud drive into a clean project folder.	free
Remotion	Optional branded promos and end cards.	free

What you actually pay for: your Claude Code plan, plus usage on the AssemblyAI and Gemini keys you connect. Everything that cuts, reframes, captions and renders runs on free, open tools on your own computer.

03 · THE WORKFLOW

How a clip gets made

You give one instruction and the kit walks this path. The tags mark where your taste comes in.

```
> /edit "cut this Q&A into 6 vertical clips"
```

01 **Set up the project.** Copy the footage from a file, link or drive into a clean folder: source, work, deliver. Originals are never touched.

02 **Read the footage.** Find faces, camera angles and audio levels so later steps frame and cut correctly.

03 **Transcribe.** Word-level timings with speakers and fillers, the spine for every cut.

04 **Find the best moments.** Score candidates against a real editorial rubric and rank them. YOUR TASTE

05 **Lock the in and out.** Each clip gets a hook, context and payoff, with no clipped words or false endings.

06 **Cut and clean.** Remove filler, dead air and stumbles, joining on silences so it sounds natural.

07 **Reframe to vertical.** Face-tracked 9:16 that keeps the speaker centered. YOUR LOOK

08 **Caption.** Word-by-word captions in your font, colors and emphasis style. YOUR STYLE

09 **Add music.** Match a track to each clip's energy and sit it under the voice. YOUR MUSIC

10 **Render.** Built in cached stages, so a later fix rebuilds only what changed.

11 **Check: six gates.** Every gate must pass. A clip that fails one does not ship.

12 **Deliver.** Finished clips land in the deliver folder for your final look, or go straight to Frame.io and Monday.

> **Revisions are targeted.** Fix a caption typo and only the caption stage runs again, not the whole clip.

The six check gates

This is what makes it safe to run hands-off. After each render, six separate checks each look at one thing, without knowing how the clip was made. All six must pass.

GATE 1
Mechanics
Resolution, length, black or frozen frames, clean first and last frames.

GATE 2
Story
A real hook, one clear arc, and a payoff that lands on the last line.

GATE 3
Picture
Face tracking and framing hold, with no jarring jumps or artifacts.

GATE 4
Sound
No clipped words, pops or level jumps. Music sits under the voice.

GATE 5
Captions
Accurate words, tight timing, correct colors, emphasis and placement.

GATE 6
Script
Would a cold viewer follow it? Context arrives before the payoff.

It learns from you. When you give feedback on a clip, the fix becomes a standing rule, so the same mistake does not ship twice. That is why the output gets better each cycle instead of drifting.

More in the box

Shorts are the default, but the same engine runs a few more jobs.

`/highlight`
Mines a long recording into ranked horizontal highlight videos for a subscriber-growth channel.

`/listicle-short`
Turns a long video into a numbered, rapid-fire 60-second list short.

`/promo`
Branded promo videos and end cards built with Remotion.

`/monday`
Sends a finished batch to Frame.io and Monday.com with your brand routes and file names.

What you plug in

The kit is brand-neutral on purpose. These five inputs make the clips look and sound like you instead of a template.

1. **Your footage**
   Drop raw recordings into the project's `00_SOURCE/` folder, or hand it a YouTube or drive link. The kit always copies first.

2. **Your clip taste**
   What makes a moment worth clipping for your audience: your hooks, topics and the kind of payoff you end on. Write it once and every batch uses it.

3. **Your caption look**
   Font, colors, emphasis and position. Free Montserrat ships as the default; drop your own font into `brand/fonts/`.

4. **Your music**
   Point `DROPIN_MUSIC` at your royalty-free library. The kit matches a track to each clip's energy and avoids repeating one within a batch.

5. **Your connections**
   AssemblyAI and Gemini keys, plus Groq for the audit gates. The agent walks you through each one and saves it privately on your machine, never in the repo or the chat.

> All of it lives in plain text and config files. No code changes needed to make it yours.

06 · GET RUNNING

Install and run

What you need

A Mac, **Claude Code** and **Homebrew** (brew.sh). Claude Code installs everything else for you.

1 · Get the kit

Download it from GitHub (Code → Download ZIP) and unzip it.

```
github.com/Louiefigz/dropin-editing
```

2 · Let the agent set you up

Open the folder in Claude Code and say **"Set up DropIn AI Editor for me."** It installs the tools, connects your keys one at a time and makes a test clip.

3 · Make clips

```
/edit <your youtube link>
```

Finished, checked clips land in the project's `20_DELIVER/` folder.

Check readiness

Ask Claude Code to "check my setup", or run:

```
bash setup.sh
```

First run

Test one short clip end to end to confirm ffmpeg, your keys and your assets are wired up. After that, batches just work.

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